



Cambridge Assessment International Education
Cambridge International General Certificate of Secondary Education

FIRST LANGUAGE ENGLISH

0500/11

Paper 1 Reading Passages (Core)

May/June 2019

READING BOOKLET INSERT

1 hour 45 minutes

READ THESE INSTRUCTIONS FIRST

This Reading Booklet Insert contains the reading passages for use with **all** the questions on the Question Paper.

You may annotate this Reading Booklet Insert and use the blank spaces for planning.

This Reading Booklet Insert is **not** assessed by the Examiner.

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This document consists of **4** printed pages.



Cambridge Assessment
International Education

Part 1

Read **Passage A** carefully, and then answer **Questions 1** and **2** on the Question Paper.

Passage A: Hang-gliding in Rio

In this passage, the writer describes their experience of hang-gliding while on holiday in Rio de Janeiro.

Rio de Janeiro appeals to everyone. From the natural wonder of Rio's harbour to the mountain top paradise of Sugarloaf, Rio has got it all: world-class carnivals and two of the most famous beaches in the world, Ipanema and Copacabana. But I only had a week there and was desperate to try something I'd heard about long before arriving in Brazil. I was going to go hang-gliding.

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Paulo was a nice guy and spoke perfect English. I was a bit nervous because I didn't know anything about hang-gliding. He assured me everything was going to be OK and that he had completed thousands of jumps before. When we arrived at the registration hut to sign my life away, I found it strange that nobody else was going. That made me nervous. Nonetheless, I proceeded to the van to be driven up several thousand metres to the jump ramp.

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As we arrived at the jump site, I looked out over the ledge and saw nothing but a vast carpet of trees and, in the distance, the Atlantic Ocean thousands of metres down. Paulo told me what he wanted me to do:

'When I say: "1, 2, 3, go!" You run and then jump off the mountain.' This seemed pretty logical: just run and jump off a sheer cliff. I love jumping off mountains having no idea what's going on. So, I shrugged my shoulders and decided he must know what he's doing.

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A savage wind buffeted us. Paulo said we would be able to stay up for half an hour and I would definitely be getting my money's worth while drifting helplessly around thousands of metres up in the air. I found myself on the ramp ready to hurl myself off into a perilous abyss. Paulo screamed, 'Go!' As I took my final step off the ramp, I heard that all too familiar voice in my head saying, 'Why are you doing this, you fool?'

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To this day I still haven't come up with a good answer, but maybe that, in fact, is the answer. I don't know why, it's just something that I am drawn to. Not everybody likes to live life on the edge and feel the rush of putting your life in danger, especially in someone else's hands. I get adrenaline pumping through my veins just thinking about it. After the initial screaming, and realising that I was still in the air and not going to crash and die, it was just me, Paulo and the passing birds. I was soaring through the air with a clear view of the most beautiful city in the world.

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Half an hour later, we started descending. I was very sad to be landing, but if I had to land somewhere it might as well be on a beautiful beach in Rio de Janeiro. As we came down, Paulo unstrapped my legs so I could land and run with the momentum of the hang-glider, but of course this ended up with me flat on my back. I didn't care: I was so happy I had experienced something that most people will never do.

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My trip to Rio de Janeiro was full of highlights and it's hard to pick one thing that really stands out because it is such a great international city. After we landed, Paulo showed

me some of his favourite parts of the city, but nothing beat the trip flying above it. I would recommend Rio de Janeiro to anyone who asks and if you do happen to go hang-gliding, tell Paulo I will see him again next time I am in Rio.

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Part 2

Read **Passage B** carefully, and then answer **Question 3** on the Question Paper.

Passage B: Flying squirrels

Although they are called flying squirrels, these small mammals do not really fly: they glide using a thin, furred membrane of skin that extends from their wrists to their ankles. By gliding with outstretched arms and legs, the flying squirrel is able to move about the tree tops, for up to 90 metres at a time. Holding onto the tree trunk, the squirrel judges the distance and, using its hind legs, it leaps into the air. During 'flight' the arms and legs are stretched to form a flat surface area for gliding. The tail flips downward and is used for steering and as a brake. The feather-light landing takes place in a vertical, upright position with the back feet making contact first.

Weighing 100–167 grams, the flying squirrel is the smallest of all the squirrels. They make a soft churning noise or a chirp. They use lichen, dried grass, and finely shredded bark to make nests in tree cavities. Sometimes they will make use of an abandoned woodpecker nest. When natural cavities are scarce, an abandoned bird's nest will be modified. In some areas, they nest in bird boxes and in attics.

Their velvet soft fur varies in colour, ranging from cinnamon or grey to a red or blackish-brown. The tail is broad, flattened and fluffy. Large, black eyes dominate the head and the ears are small and lightly furred.

The squirrels' diet consists of berries, blossom, buds, cherries, and nuts, supplemented by insects, stolen bird's eggs, or small nestling birds. The major predators are foxes, weasels, martens, and owls. Protection is found by living in the trees and being active after dark. It is the only squirrel species that is nocturnal and spends the majority of its life in a tree. Hence, most people have never seen the spectacular sight of a flying squirrel gliding through the air.

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FIRST LANGUAGE ENGLISH

0500/11

Paper 1 Reading Passages (Core)

May/June 2019

1 hour 45 minutes

Candidates answer on the Question Paper.

Additional Materials: Reading Booklet Insert

READ THESE INSTRUCTIONS FIRST

Write your centre number, candidate number and name in the spaces provided at the top of this page.

Write in dark blue or black pen.

Do not use staples, paper clips, glue or correction fluid.

DO **NOT** WRITE IN ANY BARCODES.

Answer **all** questions in the space provided. If additional space is required, you should use the lined pages at the end of the booklet. The question number(s) must be clearly shown.

Dictionaries are **not** permitted.

The Reading Booklet Insert contains the reading passages for use with **all** questions on this Question Paper. The Reading Booklet Insert is **not** assessed by the Examiner.

The number of marks is given in brackets [] at the end of each question or part question.

This document consists of **12** printed pages and **4** blank pages.

Read carefully **Passage A, *Hang-gliding in Rio***, in the Reading Booklet Insert and then answer **Questions 1** and **2** on this Question Paper.

Answer all questions using your own words as far as possible.

Question 1

- (a) Reread the **second** sentence (lines 1–3). Give **one** word that suggests Rio de Janeiro is an outstanding place to visit.

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.....

..... [1]

- (b) **Using your own words**, explain why the writer did not feel confident about hang-gliding (paragraph 2, 'Paulo was ...').

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..... [2]

- (c) **Using your own words**, explain what the writer means when he says: 'I looked out over the ledge and saw nothing but a vast carpet of trees ...' (lines 12–13).

.....

..... [2]

- (d) Give the meaning of the underlined words in the following **three** phrases as the writer uses them in the passage. Then explain how the phrases help you understand the conditions at the jump site.

- (i) 'This seemed pretty logical: just run and jump off a sheer cliff.' (lines 15–16)

Meaning of the underlined word as the writer uses it:

..... [1]

- (ii) Explanation of the **whole phrase**:

.....

.....

..... [2]

- (iii) 'A savage wind buffeted us.' (line 19)

Meaning of the underlined word as the writer uses it:

..... [1]

- (iv) Explanation of the **whole phrase**:

.....

.....

..... [2]

- (v) 'I found myself on the ramp ready to hurl myself off into a perilous abyss.' (lines 21–22)

Meaning of the underlined word as the writer uses it:

..... [1]

- (vi) Explanation of the **whole phrase**:

.....

.....

..... [2]

- (e) **Using your own words**, explain why the writer asks himself: 'Why are you doing this, you fool?' (line 23)

.....

..... [2]

- (f) Reread paragraph 6 ('To this day ...'). **Using your own words**, explain **two** things that the writer enjoys about his experience of hang-gliding.

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..... [2]

- (g) Reread paragraph 7 ('Half an hour ...'). **Using your own words**, explain what happens when the writer reaches the end of his hang-gliding trip.

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..... [2]

[Total: 20]

Question 2

Imagine you are Paulo, the guide in **Passage A**. The day after these events you write a letter to a friend describing your experience taking the writer on their hang-gliding trip.

Write your letter.

In the letter you should comment on:

- the place where you take people hang-gliding
- your impression of the writer and what they thought about their hang-gliding experience
- what happened after you landed.

Base your letter on what you have read in Passage A, but do not copy from it. Be careful to use your own words. Address each of the three bullet points.

Begin your letter: 'Dear ...'

Write about 200 to 300 words.

Up to 10 marks are available for the content of your answer, and up to 5 marks for the quality of your writing.

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Read carefully **Passage B, *Flying squirrels***, in the Reading Booklet Insert and then answer **Question 3(a)** and **3(b)** on this Question Paper.

Question 3

Answer the questions in the order set.

(a) Notes

What do you learn about the appearance of flying squirrels **and** how they fly (or glide), according to **Passage B**?

Write your answers using short **notes**. **Write one point per line.**

You do **not** need to use your own words.

Up to 10 marks are available for the content of your answer.

The appearance of flying squirrels and how they fly (or glide):

- 1
- 2
- 3
- 4
- 5
- 6
- 7
- 8
- 9
- 10 [10]

(b) Summary

Now use your notes to write a summary of what **Passage B** tells you about **the appearance of flying squirrels and how they fly (or glide)**.

You must use **continuous writing** (not note form) and **use your own words** as far as possible.

Your summary should not be more than 150 words.

Up to 5 marks are available for the quality of your writing.

This image shows a single page of white paper with horizontal blue or grey ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page, leaving small margins at the top and bottom. There are no vertical margin lines, text, or other markings on the page.

[5]

[Total: 15]

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This image shows a full page of a handwriting practice worksheet. It consists of multiple rows of horizontal dashed lines spaced evenly down the page, providing a guide for letter height and placement. The background is plain white, and there are no margins or additional markings.

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